The product and launch boundary

Verified students trade, rent, hire and discover campus offers. UniCirq owns the technology and trust layer; students and partners supply the inventory.

01 / Decisions that define the business

• Start with one dense campus; expand only after liquidity and operating costs are repeatable.

• Keep peer-to-peer resale at INR 0 commission. Earn through optional transaction support, boosts, business products and later partner margins.

• Support direct deals, but reserve verified completion history, reviews, deposit handling and payment dispute support for eligible on-platform orders.

• Operate storage through vetted partners and merchandise through preorders. Do not lease a warehouse or buy hardware stock for the pilot.

02 / MVP versus later phases

Launch MVP	After pilot gates
Student verification; campus discovery; buy/sell listings; chat; saved items; student requests and basic matching.	Cross-campus discovery; advanced recommendations; university integrations.
Basic rentals; services; verified business profiles and offers; eligible provider-backed payments; QR/OTP handover; reviews.	Storage partner booking; club merchandise preorders; paid business plans; advanced campaign analytics.
Admin moderation; reports/disputes; refunds; rental evidence; permission controls; audit logs; core metrics.	Insurance partnerships; managed selling; selected owned inventory only after demand evidence. No wallet in initial roadmap.

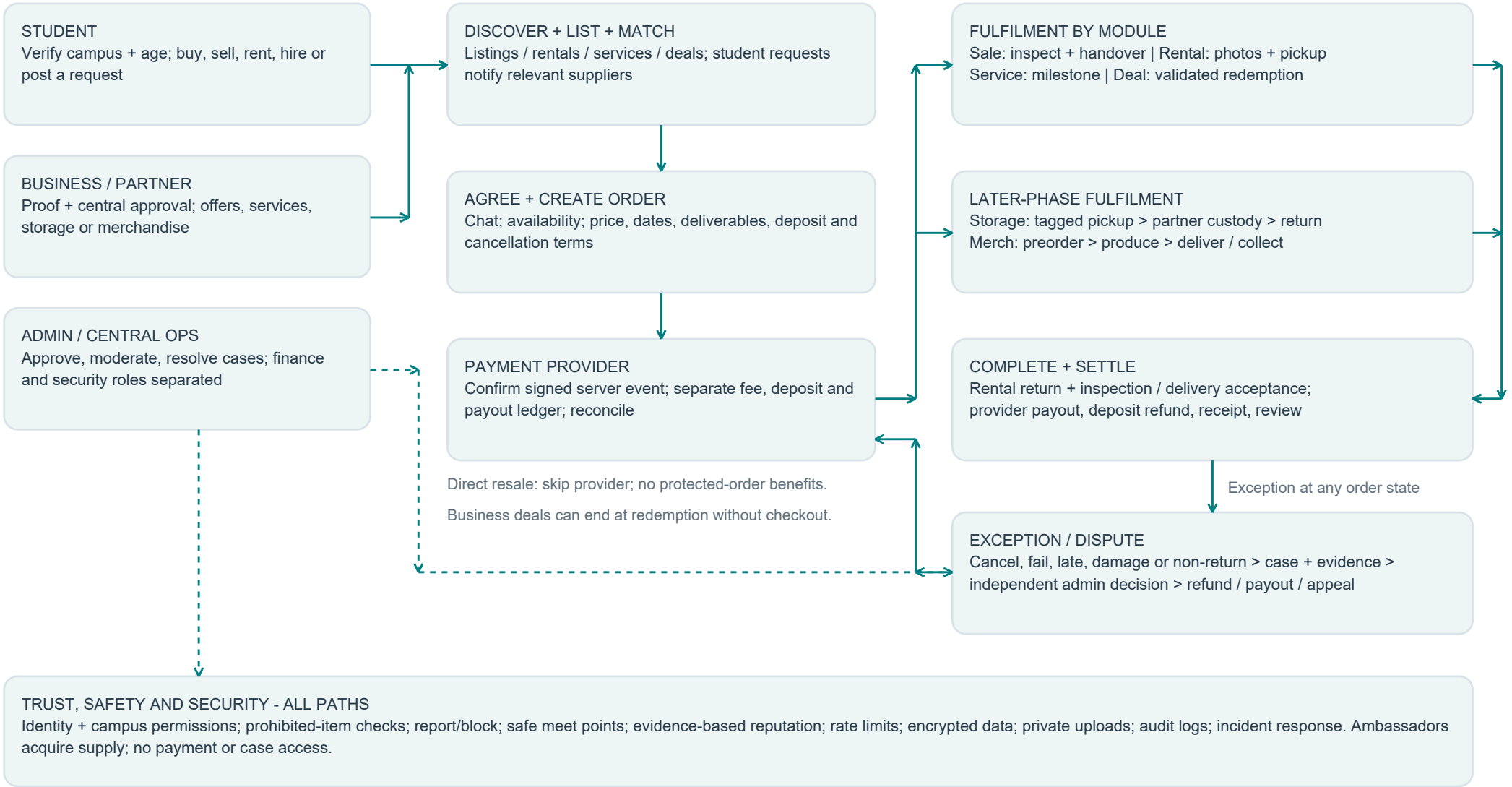
03 / Pricing direction

Pilot: free resale and business access; rental support fee INR 10-25 where viable; optional boosts INR 19-49. Services may be free initially. Later test Featured INR 499/month and Growth INR 999/month against merchant renewal and measurable value.

Basis: latest accessible conversation decisions take precedence. The previous V3 attachment and older detailed turns were unavailable. Financial scenarios, policy time windows, architecture and KPI gates in this blueprint are explicit planning proposals, not validated historical facts.

Complete system workflow

Solid arrows show order flow. Dashed governance links apply to every module. Storage and merchandise are later-phase paths.



Transaction rules and money movement

Proposed operating defaults. Publish the applicable policy before checkout; provider capabilities and signed partner contracts must support it.

Module	Required flow and completion
Buy / sell	Listed > inquiry > accepted > reserved > provider payment confirmed > buyer inspection + one-time handover QR > completion > payout eligible > review. Direct deals may close listings but do not earn verified transaction reviews.
Rental	Date/stock lock > agreement + accessory list > rent and deposit confirmed > pickup photos + QR > active > return QR + photos > inspection > deposit refund / evidence claim > close. Fee and deposit tracked separately.
Service	Scope, deadline, revisions and acceptance criteria > accepted quote > payment/milestone > delivery evidence > acceptance or case > payout. No academic cheating or impersonation.
Storage - later	Partner capacity quote > item inventory + exclusions > payment > tagged pickup receipt/photos > partner custody log > return identity check + QR > inspection > settlement or loss/damage case.
Merchandise - later	Club/design permission > preorder + size + cutoff + minimum quantity > payment > production only if threshold met > QC > pickup/delivery > completion. Threshold missed: cancel + refund.
Requests / deals	Request with category, budget and dates > campus matching > supplier reply > convert to sale/rental/service order; expire stale requests. Business offer > eligibility check > one-use redemption > business confirms; no duplicate claims.

State and exception controls

Common order: Requested > Accepted > Awaiting payment > Paid > Fulfilment > Completed > Settlement pending > Settled > Reviewed. Payment, deposit and dispute states remain separate. A successful refund is provider-confirmed, not merely requested.

Branches: unpaid expiry releases stock; provider failure keeps order unpaid; paid cancellation calculates the published refund; dispute pauses only eligible unsettled funds. Already-paid money may require recovery; never promise automatic reversal. Stock and date locks prevent double bookings.

Rental and fulfilment defaults

24-hour rental inspection/claim window; reminders 24 hours before due time; late fees stated and capped before acceptance. Normal wear is excluded. Claims require timestamped before/after photos, accessory inventory and documented repair cost; owner cannot unilaterally keep the deposit. Non-return escalates to central safety operations. Proposed service acceptance window: 48 hours with reminders and accessible dispute entry.

Payment gate: choose an authorised provider that explicitly supports the sellers, rental deposits, delayed settlement and refunds. No UniCirq-held escrow or wallet. If that model is unsupported, defer protected checkout for that category; do not simulate protection using ordinary UPI transfers.

Role-based dashboards and permissions

Separate student, business and admin entry points can share one identity service. Every request enforces role, campus and resource ownership on the server.

Role	Dashboard / authority
Student	Explore; buy/sell; rentals; services; requests; deals; chat; my listings/orders; returns; cases; saved items; privacy settings. Later: storage bookings and merchandise. View own evidence and finances only.
Business / partner	Profile and verification status; listings/services/offers; availability; orders/redemptions; provider settlement status; customer support; billing and campaign performance. Access only its own organisation and assigned orders.
Campus lead / ambassador	Referral and campaign links; onboarding tasks; public supply gaps; aggregate campus progress. Submit leads and safety reports. No student ID documents, chats, deposits, refunds or confidential case records.
Moderator	Listing/report queues; prohibited content; business/student verification within assigned scope; reasoned warnings/takedowns. No payout edits or infrastructure access.
Support / dispute officer	Assigned cases; order evidence; party responses; policy decision; escalation and appeal. Request financial action; cannot independently approve own high-value refund.
Finance	Reconciliation; failed payouts/refunds; approved financial actions; business invoices; revenue reporting. Restricted personal data; audited actions and dual approval above a configured threshold.
Security / administrator	Security incidents; access grants; system health; audit trails. MFA and time-limited access. Super-admin reserved for emergency recovery; no shared accounts.

Data and operational boundaries

• A student may also sell or provide services; this does not grant business or admin permissions. Business users switch organisation context explicitly.

• Business approval checks contact, location, ownership/proof and relevant permissions. Reverify student campus eligibility periodically and at graduation.

• Dashboard totals come from server records: provider-confirmed payments, actual redemptions and completed orders. Mark sponsored results clearly.

Trust, safety and system architecture

A practical initial build: mobile-first responsive application, modular backend and reliable background jobs. Scale only the components with measured bottlenecks.

Trust and dispute process

• Verify campus email where available; alternative ID review uses restricted access and deletes raw proof after the approved retention period. Display verification status, never public IDs or exact hostel addresses.

• Use New / Verified / Trusted / Highly Trusted levels with published criteria. Count eligible completed on-platform orders and rental returns; prevent reciprocal review farming. Provide correction and appeal.

• Report/block is available from listings, profiles and chat. Screen prohibited, stolen, dangerous and counterfeit goods; restrict high-value rentals during the pilot. Recommend staffed, well-lit campus meet points.

• Case flow: intake + severity triage > preserve order/chat/photos > both-party response > independent decision > authorised refund/payout > reasoned notice > appeal to another reviewer. Proposed response SLA: 24 hours; urgent safety triage immediately.

• Protection means defined payment, evidence and dispute services. Do not imply theft insurance, guaranteed compensation or universal coverage. Publish exclusions and caps; add insurance only with a contracted insurer.

Core architecture

Client > authenticated API > modules: identity/campus, catalogue/search, requests/matching, chat, bookings/orders, payment adapter, disputes, reputation, business campaigns and admin. Relational database is the source of truth; private object storage holds evidence; job queue runs notifications, expiry, matching and reconciliation.

Key records: User, Campus, Membership, Organisation, Listing, Availability, Request, Quote, Order, OrderEvent, Payment, Deposit, Refund, Payout, Handover, Review, Case, Consent and AuditEvent. Snapshot agreed terms in each order; do not let listing edits rewrite them.

Security and reliability requirements

• MFA for privileged users; least privilege; campus/organisation isolation; secure session expiry; encrypted transport and storage; managed secrets; no card data stored.

• Signed payment webhooks; idempotent order/payment actions; replay protection; expiring one-time QR/OTP tied to order, party and action. Provider event + reconciliation, never screenshot, confirms payment.

• Validate uploads and scan files; signed private download links; rate limits on login/chat/listing creation; abuse detection; audit sensitive actions without logging credentials.

• Backups plus tested restores; monitoring for errors, queue lag and payment mismatches; incident runbook and on-call owner. Proposed pilot recovery targets: RPO 24 hours, RTO 8 hours; tighten before expansion.

Unit economics and seasonality

Illustrative one-campus model in INR, excluding GST. These are planning inputs, not a forecast. Deposits and seller proceeds are liabilities/pass-throughs, never platform revenue.

Typical teaching month	Activity x price	Platform revenue
Protected rentals	120 x 20 fee; rental GMV 120 x 400	2,400
Resale / services	Free at pilot; excluded from fee revenue	0
Optional boosts	40 x 29	1,160
Businesses - later test	8 Featured x 499 + 2 Growth x 999	5,990
Total mature teaching month	Rental GMV 48,000; boosts/plans separate	9,550
Pilot, business plans free	Rental fees + boosts only	3,560

Contribution, not just gross revenue

Illustrative variable cost: 3% of INR 48,000 rental GMV = INR 1,440 processing; 120 x INR 5 = INR 600 support/loss provision; INR 200 boost/business servicing. Mature contribution = INR 7,310/month. Pilot contribution = INR 1,520. Reprice if the provider charges on deposits or refunds; quote tax and fees explicitly.

Illustrative monthly fixed allocation: campus lead INR 3,000 + ambassador/campaign pool INR 1,500 + shared hosting/central support INR 2,000 = INR 6,500. Mature campus surplus: INR 810; pilot deficit: INR 4,980. This excludes founder pay, development, central overhead beyond allocation, tax and extraordinary losses.

Annual seasonal check - proposed scenario

Period	Revenue / contribution	Operating implication
8 teaching months	8 x 9,550 / 8 x 7,310	Demand from rentals, requests, services and deals.
2 transition months	Each: base at 75% + 50 storage x 100 margin + 100 merch x 80 margin = 20,163 revenue; 15,883 contribution.	Partner payouts already removed from margins; assume further 20% handling/loss cost on seasonal margins.
2 holiday months	Each: base at 25% = 2,388 revenue; 1,828 contribution.	Storage peaks around departure/return, not every holiday month.

Annual result: revenue INR 121,500; contribution INR 93,900; fixed allocation INR 78,000; surplus INR 15,900 before excluded costs. Without storage/merch contribution: INR 4,900 annual deficit. Validate partner capacity and demand before relying on seasonal revenue.

Break-even teaching month: (6,500 + 2,240 variable costs - 3,560 non-B2B revenue) / 599 average business plan = 8.65, or about 9 paying merchants, assuming the same mix and volumes. CAC = acquisition spend / newly activated verified users; payback uses realised contribution, not GMV.

Sensitivity: a 3% charge on 120 deposits of INR 1,000 adds INR 3,600/month and turns the teaching-month surplus into a deficit. Paid resale/services, additional staff and refunds need separate cost lines before activation.

Cold start and anti-bypass strategy

Launch liquidity before broad promotion. Seed genuine supply and real requests; measure fulfilment instead of downloads.

Prelaunch inventory and demand

Seed target	Acquisition source
150-250 used-product listings	Graduating students and hostel residents; Campus Clearance Week.
25-40 rental items; 20-30 hardware items	Clubs, project teams, labs with permission and local stores. Hardware may overlap rental/sale listings; deduplicate counts.
20-30 service providers	Tutors, designers, editors and photographers; verify scope and availability.
5-10 businesses; 10+ campus offers	Ambassador lead links; central approval; track actual redemptions.
20-30 genuine student requests	Capture unmet demand; notify relevant suppliers; expire fulfilled/stale requests.
1-2 club merchandise collections	Later-phase readiness only; activate after partner and order controls pass.

Four-stage launch

Private seed: 50-100 users - assisted listing creation and interviews.
Closed beta: 200-300 - verify payment, handover, return and dispute flows.
Campus beta: 500-1,000 - improve search availability and request fulfilment.
Public campus launch: 1,500+ - widen acquisition and test paid value. User counts are planning milestones; quality gates still apply.

Seasonal campaign calendar

Semester start: Hostel Setup Week; furniture, cycles and books.
Practical/project weeks: hardware matching and short rentals.
Fest season: campus talent, services and club preorders.
Semester end/graduation: clearance listings and move-out sales.
Holiday departure/return: partner storage booking windows and return scheduling.

Keep users through value

• Give early sellers free featured placement for 30 days. Reward fulfilled demand and useful supply; never pay for empty registrations.

• Bundle payment confirmation, verification, deposit records, QR evidence, reminders, cases and verified history into eligible on-platform orders. Charge a transparent support fee only when that bundle works.

• Allow sharing of listings and requests; use club and merchant referral loops. Keep chat useful and avoid aggressive contact blocking. Track protected-order adoption from agreed deals and ask users why they bypass.

• Send relevant replies, matches and due-date alerts with opt-outs and quiet hours. Use campus, category, availability and freshness for basic ranking before adding ML.

Campus operations and scaling

One central platform and operating team; local students acquire supply and partners fulfil physical services.

Owner	Recurring responsibility
Campus lead + 2-4 ambassadors	Recruit sellers/clubs/businesses; assist onboarding; run calendar campaigns; identify supply gaps; escalate local safety reports. Weekly campus review and lead succession plan.
Central support / moderation	Verify exceptions; approve businesses; remove prohibited content; triage reports; manage disputes and appeals under documented policies.
Central finance / security	Provider reconciliation; authorised refunds/payouts; business billing; fraud investigations; access reviews; incidents and platform reliability.
Storage / merchandise partners	Contracted capacity, custody, quality, fulfilment, loss/damage duties, insurance and response SLAs. Named escalation contact and backup partner.

Ambassador operating model

• Proposed lead stipend INR 2,000-4,000/month after a usage gate; example base model uses INR 3,000. Maintain a capped campaign incentive budget.

• Conversation examples: INR 20 per verified business lead and INR 5-10 per successful campaign referral. Pay only for approved, attributable activity; duplicates and self-referrals do not qualify.

• Use weekly targets for active listings, valid merchant leads, matched requests and retained users. Central approval controls payments; audit unusual referral clusters.

• Provide onboarding scripts, conduct rules, safe-meet guidance, campaign kits and certificates. Ambassadors never mediate money claims or collect deposits personally.

Expansion gates and sequence

Campus 1: founder-led support; prove the category and payment policies.
Campuses 2-5: same playbook; adjacent geography; shared partners; compare cohort contribution.
Campuses 6-20: regional operations owner; automated verification/matching; central case QA.
Campuses 20-50: regional partner networks and specialist finance/safety teams; scale infrastructure from measured load.

Enter a campus only with a lead, sufficient seeded supply, approved merchants, support capacity and campus permission for any physical events. Keep campus visibility isolated by default; opt-in cross-campus trades need distance and handover controls. Budget incremental support and seasonal partner cost before expansion.

Weekly operating review

Review liquidity by category; stalled/late orders; return and dispute queues; payment mismatches; business renewals; campaign cost per activated user; partner failures; campus contribution. Assign an owner and deadline for every issue. Pause an unsafe category or unreliable partner rather than pushing volume.

Legal, privacy and launch safeguards

India planning summary, checked against official sources on 29 September 2026. Apply the rules relevant to the actual model; confirm launch obligations with Indian counsel and the payment provider.

Required agreements and disclosures

• Publish Terms, Privacy Notice, prohibited-items policy, payment/refund rules, rental deposit/damage rules and grievance contact. Display total charges, seller/partner identity as required, delivery terms and sponsored placements.

• Use contracts for merchants, clubs, ambassadors and storage/merch partners: service scope, cancellations, custody, loss allocation, data handling, invoices, IP permissions and escalation. Obtain permission before claiming university affiliation.

• Define UniCirq as marketplace facilitator where accurate; terms cannot remove statutory duties. Check entity registration, GST/TCS and invoicing applicability, local operations permissions and trademark availability before commercial launch.

Privacy and payments

The DPDP Rules 2025 have phased commencement; map each obligation to its effective date rather than assuming all provisions apply today [1]. Build clear purpose-specific notices, consent records where needed, withdrawal, correction/deletion/grievance routes and vendor controls. Proposed pilot eligibility: students aged 18+; any later minors flow needs an appropriate age/parental-consent design.

Collect only campus proof, contact and transaction data needed. Separate verification documents from public profiles. Use a retention schedule by data class: short-lived raw verification proof; purpose-limited chat/evidence; legally retained financial records; legal holds for active cases. Deletion must propagate to vendors/backups on the documented schedule; do not promise immediate deletion of all records.

Use an authorised payment provider; confirm merchant onboarding/KYC, deposits, settlement and refund support in writing. UniCirq must not independently operate a payment system without applicable authorisation [2]. Do not represent provider settlement services as a UniCirq escrow licence.

Consumer complaints and incident readiness

Where the E-Commerce Rules apply, acknowledge consumer grievances within 48 hours and redress within one month [3]. An internal 24-hour response target is stricter; it does not replace statutory deadlines. Keep decisions, refunds and appeal routes traceable.

CERT-In directions require covered entities to report specified cyber incidents within 6 hours and maintain ICT logs for a rolling 180 days in India [4]. Appoint an incident contact; preserve evidence; maintain required time synchronisation. Map personal-data breach duties and timing to the applicable DPDP commencement provisions.

Official reference links

[1] MeitY: DPDP Rules 2025 and enforcement timeline
[2] RBI: payment systems authorisation FAQ
[3] Department of Consumer Affairs: official annual report, E-Commerce Rules summary
[4] CERT-In: directions dated 28 April 2022

Launch KPIs and release gates

Proposed targets for the first campus; validate during beta. Count verified users and genuine completed orders, excluding tests, duplicates, cancelled orders and incentive abuse.

Metric / definition	Pilot target or gate
Search success: eligible searches returning at least one available, relevant campus result	>=70% in the top five launch categories; audit relevance.
Request fulfilment: eligible requests converted to a completed order within 7 days	>=40%; track response-only matches separately.
Time to first substantive reply	Median <=24 hours in beta; work toward <2 hours. Report p90 too.
Liquidity: live listings receiving a real inquiry within 7 days	>=30%; remove unavailable/stale supply.
Completed on-platform orders	Proposed six-month target >=150/month; show category and protected/direct split.
Repeat use: monthly transactors transacting again within 30 days	>=25%; use matured cohorts, not all signups.
Rental reliability / disputes	>=97% on-time returns; disputes <3 per 100 completed orders; track loss severity separately.
Business renewal / economics	>=60% first paid-plan renewal; positive campus contribution after local and shared allocations for 3 teaching months.
Six-month scale checkpoint	1,500 verified students + 500 active deduplicated listings + liquidity/safety gates. Adjust scope if unmet; do not expand on registrations alone.

Release checklist - owners must sign off

Product / engineering: test every module happy path and cancellation, payment failure, duplicate webhook, double booking, missed return and dispute branch. Verify cross-role/campus access denial and one-time handover controls.
Finance / provider: demonstrate reconciliation, approved payout, partial/full refund and rental-deposit release; confirm fees and allowed settlement terms.
Operations / safety: staffed case queue, escalation and appeal; real seeded stock; approved merchant and partner contracts; incident drill and backup restore.
Legal / privacy: approved notices/policies; grievance contact; retention schedule; eligibility rules; current-law and provider review.

Decision after the pilot

Expand when category liquidity, safe fulfilment, support capacity and annualised contribution are credible. Iterate when demand exists but matching, fees or workflows fail. Pause the category when loss, provider restrictions or partner unreliability make the promised service unworkable. Record the decision and evidence before Campus 2.

Central dashboard: verified MAU, activation, category GMV, recognised revenue per active student, protected-order adoption, refund/payout backlog, business retention and contribution by campus. Show monthly and seasonal cohorts.